ZUNFT

Project Guide

What Zunft is, how it works inside, which technology it uses, and what it can do today. Written for people who know what an app, a database and an API are, but do not need the details of the code.

State: 14 October 2026 | Android app + cloud | Companion documents: **Zunft_Tests** (what to test) and **Zunft_ToDo** (what you have to do)

1. What Zunft is

Zunft is an app for small German craft businesses (Handwerk): an electrician who works alone, up to a firm of about ten people. It replaces the evening of paperwork. The craftsman **talks** into the phone on site, and the app turns that into a correct, numbered invoice or quote.

1. Speak
"Steckdose im Keller, zwei Stunden, Material vierzig Euro"

→

2. Understand
Speech to text, then an AI sorts it into positions

→

3. Check
The craftsman reviews and corrects every position

→

4. Invoice
Numbered PDF (DIN 5008), optionally an e-invoice

The problems it solves

- **Paperwork after work.** Positions are created from speech, text or a photographed receipt. The craftsman only checks.
- **Tax rules for private customers (§ 35a EStG).** A private customer can deduct labour costs, but not material. The invoice therefore shows labour and material apart and prints the amounts the customer needs for the tax return.
- **Several people, one invoice.** Everything recorded on a job by anyone (voice, receipts, tracked time) is collected into **one** invoice.
- **Bad reception on site.** The app works offline and sends everything when the connection is back.
- **Legal safety.** Issued invoices can never be changed (only cancelled with a Stornorechnung), numbers have no gaps, and amounts are calculated by program code, never by the AI.

Who uses it

Role	Who	What they can do
Inhaber (owner)	The boss, or a self-employed person alone	Everything, including team, plan and settings
Büro (office)	Office staff	See and bill all jobs, plan appointments; cannot manage the team
Meister / Geselle	Workers	See only jobs assigned to them; record notes, receipts, time; mark appointments done. May create customers/jobs only if the owner switches that on

One account belongs to one person and one business. Removing someone never deletes their account; they just lose access to the business data.

2. The big picture

Zunft has three parts: the **app on the phone**, the **cloud** that keeps the data for all phones of a business, and two **AI services** that understand speech and text.

Phone app
Flutter (Dart). Own small database on the phone. Works offline.

↔

Cloud: Supabase
Database (Postgres), file storage, login, small server programs (Edge Functions), nightly jobs. Region: EU (Ireland).

↔

AI services
Deepgram (speech to text) and Google Gemini (understanding text and photos). Called only by our cloud, never by the phone.

The path of one voice note

1. The craftsman picks a job and records up to 3 minutes. The app plays it back so he can check it before sending ("Anhören / Senden / Löschen").
2. The sound file is saved on the phone first (so nothing is lost without network) and queued.
3. When online, the app uploads the file to private cloud storage and calls the Edge Function `process-capture` with the job id.
4. The function checks who is calling (login) and that the job belongs to their business, downloads the file, and asks **Deepgram** for the German text.
5. The text goes to **Gemini** with strict instructions and a fixed answer format: positions with type (labour, material, flat fee), quantity, unit, price. The text is treated as data, not as commands.
6. Our code validates the answer and calculates totals (integer cents). Prices the AI had to guess are marked "Preis prüfen".
7. The result is stored as a **note on the job**. The customer always comes from the job, never from what the AI heard.
8. The phone receives the note; the craftsman reviews all notes of the job together and issues the invoice.

> **Why the AI never calculates**
> A language model can make arithmetic mistakes. So it only *copies* what was said or printed. Net, VAT, totals, net-from-gross conversion and cross-checks against printed receipt totals are done by normal program code that is tested.

Offline and sync

The phone keeps its own copy of customers, jobs, appointments, time entries and issued documents (database **Drift/SQLite**). Every change is written locally first and put in an **outbox**. When the network is there, the outbox is sent to the cloud, in an order that respects links (customer before job, job before appointment). Then the phone pulls what others changed. If two people change the same thing, the last write wins. The only things that need internet: issuing a document (the number comes from the server), AI processing, and an employee marking an appointment done.

3. Technology used

Part	Technology	Why it is there
App framework	Flutter 3.47 / Dart	One code base; Android now, iOS later (needs a Mac to build)
State and structure	Riverpod	Keeps screens and data in step; makes testing easy
Local database	Drift (SQLite), schema version 8	Offline copy and the outbox
Cloud database	Supabase Postgres 17, 23 migrations	The single source of truth; row-level security separates businesses
Server programs	Supabase Edge Functions (Deno/TypeScript): `process-capture`, `purge-recordings`, `notify-appointment`	AI calls (keys stay on the server), nightly clean-up, push messages
Scheduling and calls from the database	pg_cron + pg_net + Supabase Vault	Nightly deletion of old recordings; a database trigger calls the push function
Files	Supabase Storage (private buckets `captures`, `documents`)	Recordings, receipt photos, PDFs, logo
Login	Supabase Auth (e-mail + password)	Accounts
Speech to text	Deepgram (model nova-2, German)	Understands trade words (keyword boosting)
Understanding text and photos	Google Gemini (`gemini-3.5-flash-lite`, structured JSON output)	Positions from text; reading receipts
PDF	`pdf`, `printing`; Lato font embedded; sRGB profile	DIN 5008 letter; PDF/A-3 for e-invoices
E-invoice	ZUGFeRD / Factur-X profile EN 16931 (XML built by our code)	Legally required for business customers from 2027/2028
Push messages	Firebase Cloud Messaging (FCM v1), `firebase_messaging`; project `zunft-7118a`	Tells a worker about a new, moved or cancelled appointment while the app is closed
Audio	`record`, `audioplayers`	Recording and playback
Camera and files	Google ML Kit document scanner, `image_picker`, `file_picker`	Receipt scanning, gallery, PDF import
Phone features	`local_auth` (fingerprint/face), `flutter_local_notifications` (reminders), `url_launcher` (call, maps), `share_plus` (WhatsApp, mail, files), `mobile_scanner` (QR), `shared_preferences`	App lock, reminders, call/route, sharing, joining by QR
Export	`archive` (ZIP), CSV with BOM	Receipt/invoice export for the tax advisor

Tests	Flutter test (500), Deno (39), SQL on PGlite (103); Mustang validator for e-invoices	See chapter 8
Source control	Git, GitHub `Rb3111-ship/Zunft`	History and backup of the code

4. How the data is organised

Everything belongs to exactly one **business**. A person has one **profile** (role) in one business.

Thing	What it is
Business	Name, address, tax number / USt-IdNr, IBAN, VAT rate, hourly rate, material markup, logo, recording retention, seat limit, storage limit, "employees may create" switch
Customer	Person or company (Herr / Frau / Firma) with address, phone, e-mail. Can be merged into another (the old record is hidden, not deleted)
Job (Auftrag)	The unit of work for one customer. Status: draft → in progress (first note) → completed / invoiced (closed). Notes, receipts, appointments and time entries hang on a job
Note (capture)	One voice, text or receipt input with the positions the AI read. A job collects many notes from many people
Document	Quote, invoice or cancellation (Stornorechnung). Locked at creation. Has a number per business, type and year (RE-, ANG-, ST-)
Appointment	A calendar entry: time, place, optional job and customer, one or more people; or an absence (holiday, sick)
Time entry	Who worked how long (start, end, break) on which job. Locked once billed
Receipt (Beleg)	A photographed or uploaded purchase document, read into material positions, kept in an archive



5. What the app does

5.1 Jobs (Aufträge)

Two tabs: **Offen** (what still needs work: in-progress first) and **Erledigt** (finished and billed; finished-but-not-billed first, because that is money to collect). A job moves to Erledigt when it is invoiced or finished by hand; a closed job accepts no new notes until the boss reopens it. The status changes to "in progress" by itself with the first note. The boss assigns workers to a job; a worker only sees jobs assigned to him.

5.2 Customers

- Created by hand or via an invoice; the customer on an invoice comes from the job.
- **Duplicates:** a name alone is never treated as a duplicate (there are many Müllers). A warning appears when the same *phone or e-mail* exists under another name, or the same name at the same address. Same name at a different address is a different person.
- **Merging** (boss and office): side-by-side comparison; jobs and appointments move to the customer you keep; missing details are filled in and different details are written into the notes. The merged record stays hidden because issued documents still point at it. There is no undo button.
- A customer who has a quote or invoice cannot be deleted (legal retention).

5.3 Capturing work

VOICE AND TEXT

Up to 3 minutes per voice note, or type instead. Listen before sending. The recording can be replayed later with every number highlighted. Recordings are kept as raw material only: they are deleted a set number of days after the job closes (default 90, the business may shorten it). The text and positions stay.

RECEIPTS (BELEGE)

For material bought for a customer: scan with the document scanner, choose a photo, or upload a PDF. The AI copies printed values; code does the arithmetic:

- **Net or gross is decided from the printed numbers**: subtotal + VAT = total means net prices; lines add up to the total means gross prices (divided by 1.19 in code). The AI's own guess does not decide.
- Warnings for: sum differs from printed total, deposit (Pfand), unreadable lines, assumed VAT rate.
- **Same receipt twice:** same file (checksum) or same receipt number + date + total (or supplier + date + total without a number). It only warns; the boss confirms.
- The material goes onto the job at purchase price plus the business's optional **markup** (receipt itself keeps the real cost). Article numbers (EAN) are stripped from invoice text.
- **Archive** "Einkaufsbelege": all receipts with status (open / billed / removed), search, and a **ZIP export** (photos per month, CSV lists) for the tax advisor.

5.4 Reviewing and invoicing

- All open notes of a job become **one draft**. Positions are typed: **labour** (Arbeitsleistung), **flat fee** (counts as labour) and **material**. Every position can be edited, added or removed.
- Positions the AI had to estimate are flagged "Preis prüfen" and must be confirmed before issuing.
- **Tracked working time** can be billed: the boss chooses to replace spoken working time with tracked time, bill both, or not now (see 5.8).
- Issuing is one server call: it checks the data, assigns the next number and stores the locked document in one step. If the connection drops, a retry returns the same document instead of a second number.
- Required before an invoice: sender address and tax number or USt-IdNr; for amounts over 250 € the customer's address.
- A quote (Angebot) is made the same way and has its own number series; it is never revenue.

5.5 Documents

- **PDF** in DIN 5008 layout with the business logo, Leistungszeitraum, payment term, bank details, and for private customers the § 35a notice with labour and material amounts. A Kleinunternehmer (VAT rate 0 %) gets the § 19 UStG note.
- **Immutable:** an issued document cannot be edited or deleted. A mistake is corrected with a **Stornorechnung** (negative amounts, own number ST-). The original is marked cancelled, its notes are released and the job reopens so the work can be billed again.
- **XRechnung for public bodies:** a customer can have a **Leitweg-ID** (the routing number an authority gives you; format checked, not the check digits). The document freezes it with the buyer's e-mail, the PDF prints it, and the document screen offers "XRechnung (XML) für Behörden teilen": a stand-alone XML in the XRechnung 3.0 profile of EN 16931, built from the stored document. It is checked against the official XRechnung rules with the Mustang tool (0 of 19 rules failed on the sample); the authority's own portal or the Zentrale Rechnungseingang is still the place where the file is sent. Needs the owner name, phone and e-mail of the business and the e-mail of the customer.
- **E-invoice (ZUGFeRD / Factur-X, EN 16931):** the same PDF is a PDF/A-3 file with the machine-readable XML inside. Pre-selected for company customers; needs complete data (checked before a number is issued). A cancellation of an e-invoice is an e-invoice credit note. Validated with the open-source Mustang validator.
- **Sending:** share sheet (WhatsApp, e-mail with the customer's address pre-filled). Status: issued → sent → paid (by hand).
- Search by number, customer, status or amount; summary of open invoices.

5.6 Calendar (Termine)

- Day and week view, week strip with dots, filter by person for the boss. Appointments belong to people, optionally to a job and a customer (address pre-filled).
- Absences (holiday, sick), all-day, multi-day.
- **Double-booking warning**: overlap in time and a shared person; you may still save.
- A worker given an appointment for a job is automatically assigned to that job.
- In an appointment: call the customer, open the route in the maps app, add to the phone calendar (.ics), send the customer a friendly confirmation text, mark done, cancel (boss).

- **Reminders** on the phone (15 min to 2 h before), planned by the phone itself, so they work with the app closed and without internet.
- **Push messages** (switch "Meldungen bei Terminen" per phone): when the boss gives a worker an appointment, moves or cancels it, takes the worker off it or deletes it, the worker's phone gets a notification even with the app closed. How: the database notices the change and calls the function `notify-appointment`, which looks up the worker's phones and sends the message through Google Firebase. Tapping the notification opens the appointment. The person who made the change is not notified. Dead phone addresses are removed automatically. Each person switches it on once, on their own phone; signing out switches it off, so a shared phone never shows someone else's messages.

5.7 Overview (Übersicht)

For boss and office: per month or year the plain sums of issued invoices (net, VAT per rate, gross, labour/material, paid/open, cancellations netted) and of purchase receipts, plus a CSV to share. It is an addition of stored records by **invoice date**, labelled "Zusammenstellung, keine Steuerberechnung". It does not compute VAT payable, profit or any tax figure.

5.8 Working time (Zeiterfassung)

- **Timer** on a job (or from an appointment): a bar above the tabs shows what is running. One timer per person; starting another stops the first. A timer over 12 hours is flagged as forgotten.
- **By hand:** "Zeit nachtragen" with start, end and break. The boss can add time for a worker; the entry is then marked "vom Betrieb eingetragen" so the worker sees who made it.
- Weekly or monthly list per person (boss) or "Meine Zeiten" (worker; only his own). "Als Datei teilen (CSV)" sends the period as a table file (hours as 7:45 and 7,75, total per person) for the accountant or payroll.
- **Hourly rate per person:** the owner taps a person under Betrieb → Team and enters an hourly rate (net). Only owner and office can see rates. Without a rate the business's rate is used.
- **On the invoice:** one position "Arbeitszeit (Zeiterfassung)" at the business's hourly rate, flagged for a price check. If people have different rates, one position per rate (named after the role, no personal names), highest rate first. The entries are then locked and not suggested again.
- No location is recorded.

> **Does the timer drain the battery? What if the app is closed?**
> No. The app does not run anything in the background. When you press start it stores a single fact: the *start time*. The clock you see is just "now minus start time", worked out whenever the screen is open (the one-second refresh only runs while the timer is visible). If the app is closed or the phone restarts, nothing is lost and nothing is consumed: the next time you open it, the elapsed time is calculated from the stored start time. Reminders use the phone's own alarm system for the same reason. If you prefer the simple way, "Zeit nachtragen" lets a worker enter only a start and an end time.

> **Boss entering time for a worker: is it legal?**
>
> Not checked, and the app does not claim it. In practice the owner is the one responsible for working-time records and many firms enter time for staff, but the rules on recording working hours, on a worker's right to see and object, and on works council co-determination need a lawyer. The app is built to be transparent: the worker sees the entry in "Meine Zeiten" marked "vom Betrieb eingetragen". There is no change log yet. This is item 3.5 in the To-Do document.

5.10 Languages

- **Screens in 13 languages:** Deutsch, English, Türkçe, العربية (Arabic, right to left), Shqip, Polski, Română, Русский, Українська, Hrvatski, Srpski (Latin script), Български and فارسی (Persian, right to left). The first start follows the phone's language if it is one of them, otherwise German. Everyone chooses their own on the login screen or under Betrieb → Sprache; the choice is stored on the phone.
- **How it works:** the German text in the code is the key. A table maps each German text to its translations; a text without a translation simply stays German. New screens therefore never break; they are just not translated yet.
- **What stays German on purpose:** quotes, invoices, e-invoices (also the XRechnung), the covering text of a mail, file names and the privacy notice (needs the lawyer). A PDF is never made in another language: one invoice, one language.
- **Push messages and reminders follow the app language:** each phone tells the server its app language when it registers (and again when the language changes); the server writes the title in that language, the weekday too. The reminders planned on the phone are re-planned when the language changes.
- **Speaking or typing a note in your own language:** the app sends its language with the note. For a language other than German, Gemini listens, writes down what was said in the original language *and* translates it into German; the German text then goes through the normal step that makes positions. Because a translation can be wrong, **every position of such a note is marked "Preis prüfen"** and a warning says it was translated. Tested with spoken sentences in all 12 other languages: items, quantities, hours and prices were right in every case; names and filler words sometimes were not. The test used clean computer-made speech, real noisy site recordings will be worse: it must be tried by native speakers. German notes still use the German speech recognition (Deepgram) as before. For other languages the audio goes to Google (Gemini) instead.
- **Not done:** a translation check by native speakers (see the To-Do document).

5.11 Subscription and access

- **One subscription per business.** A self-employed person is a business with 1 seat; a company is a business with several seats, paid by the owner. Workers follow the status of the business.
- **States:** *trial* (14 days free for a new business), *active* (paid), *past due* (a payment failed; everything still works for 7 more days), *canceled* (works until the end of the paid period). Only we can change the state, never the app.
- **When access has ended the business is read-only, not locked out:** everything can still be viewed and exported, existing records can be edited and an invoice can still be cancelled (Storno). Nothing new can be created: customers, jobs, notes, receipts, appointments, working time, quotes and invoices. The database refuses it, so an old app version cannot get around it; note processing answers "subscription expired" before spending AI money.

- **In the app:** a strip above the tabs (amber in the last 7 days of a trial, red when payment is late or access has ended), a short explanation when someone taps a "new" button, and for the owner a button "Abo verlängern" ("Abo abschließen" during the trial) that opens the payment page. Until that page exists the app says so. The address is set at build time (`BILLING_URL`).
- **Not built yet:** the payment page and the Stripe link that keeps the state up to date automatically (today the state is set by hand in SQL). Prices are proposed in **Zunft_Preise**.

5.9 Security and privacy in the app

- **Row-level security:** the database itself refuses to show or change another business's data, and an employee only sees what is assigned to them. This is enforced in the database, not only in the app.
- **App lock** (fingerprint, face or phone PIN) per phone, with a timeout; sign-out always works.
- **Storage limit** per business (default 1 GB, set by us); uploads are refused when full, invoices are never blocked.
- **Recording retention** (default 90 days after job closure), enforced nightly by the server.
- The employee privacy notice in the app lists what is stored. It is a draft for a lawyer.
- Secret keys (Deepgram, Gemini, cron secret) exist only on the server.

6. Rules that protect the business

Rule	What it means in practice
Money is whole cents	No rounding drift. 19,00 € is stored as 1900.
The AI never calculates	It copies words and printed numbers. Code does all arithmetic and cross-checks.
Issued documents are frozen (GoBD)	The database refuses edits and deletes of a locked document. Only the status (sent, paid, cancelled) may change.
No gaps in numbers	Numbers come from a counter per business, type and year, assigned inside the same transaction as the document.
Billed time and notes are used up	The server marks them with the document in the same transaction; they cannot appear on a second invoice.
Nothing is guessed silently	Estimates, doubtful receipts, possible duplicates and forgotten timers are shown to the user.
Legal wording is a proposal	Texts such as the § 35a note are drafts until the tax advisor confirms them.

7. Decisions that stand

- **Gemini, not Claude,** for parsing (cost). Deepgram stays for speech; no model change and no multi-language yet.
- A flat fee (Anfahrt, Notdienst) counts as labour for § 35a; the advisor must confirm.
- One business per account. Owner account deletion is a support process (invoices must be kept by law).
- Payments are deferred: seat and storage limits are set by hand in SQL.
- **Deliberately not built:** bank connection and payment matching, link to the customer's own cloud, quote-to-invoice conversion, own price list, any tax calculation (VAT payable, EÜR, Voranmeldung), DATEV export before the advisor says what is needed.

What is not built yet

Item	Why it waits
XRechnung (XML only, for public bodies)	Only needed when invoicing a public authority. The authority gives you its **Leitweg-ID** (a routing number printed in its order, contract or invoicing instructions; you do not apply for one). Then a customer field and the XRechnung identifiers are added. The ZUGFeRD part is done and validated
Push on iPhone	Needs the iOS app (Mac, Apple developer account) and an Apple push key in Firebase
Reading the XML of received e-invoices	The original PDF with its XML is stored unchanged, so nothing is lost
iOS app	Needs a Mac and an Apple developer account
Payments and plans	Pricing decision first
Multi-page receipts as one, per-person hourly rates, rounding of tracked time, time CSV	Not asked for yet
Lawyer and tax advisor sign-off	Questions are prepared in **Zunft_Steuerberater.pdf**; see To-Do

8. How quality is checked

Kind of test	Count	What it proves
App tests (Flutter)	564	Screens, flows, calculations, sync, permissions, offline behaviour, with a fake server. Includes validation of e-invoice files with the Mustang tool when it is installed
Server logic tests (Deno)	47	The AI-answer validation, the receipt arithmetic, and the push messages (wording, Google sign-in, error handling)
Database tests (SQL on PGlite)	114	Row-level security for every role, numbering, locking, cancellation, appointments, time entries, retention, e-invoice flag
Live checks	several	Rolled-back scripts against the real database, real receipt read by the real AI, storage limit enforcement, e-invoice validation of a sample

> **What is NOT verified**
> Everything that needs a real phone: microphone, camera and scanner, fingerprint/face, share sheet, notifications after a reboot, battery behaviour, and the look and feel. That is what **Zunft_Tests.pdf** is for. Legal correctness (tax texts, working-time rules, privacy) is not tested by software at all; see the To-Do.

Costs to expect (orientation only)

- Per voice note: a few cents of Deepgram and Gemini together (measure with real use).
- Supabase: a free project is paused after a week of inactivity (two of your older projects show "INACTIVE"); a paid plan is needed for real customers.
- Stores: Google Play one-time fee; Apple yearly fee for iOS.

9. For developers: where things are

Where	What
`zunft_app/lib/features/`	One folder per feature: auth, team, customers, jobs, capture, review, documents, receipts, appointments, time_tracking, overview. Each has domain (rules), data (server access), application (providers), presentation (screens)
`zunft_app/lib/core/`	Local database, sync engine, security (app lock), theme, utilities
`zunft_app/test/`	All app tests and fakes (`test/helpers`)
`supabase/migrations/`	The database, step by step (23 files, applied in order)
`supabase/functions/`	Edge Functions and their shared, tested logic (`_shared`)
`supabase/tests/`	SQL tests (`node --test` in that folder)
`docs/`	These documents and the tax advisor question list
`CLAUDE.md`	Working notes, decisions, roadmap and build commands for the AI assistant

Build the Android app: `flutter build apk --release --dart-define=SUPABASE_URL=... --dart-define=SUPABASE_ANON_KEY=...` (the public key only; secret keys never go into the app). Run the app tests with `flutter test`.

Glossary

§ 35a EStG	Tax relief for private customers on labour costs of craftsmen (not material)
DIN 5008	German standard layout for business letters
GoBD	German rules for proper, unchangeable electronic bookkeeping
Stornorechnung	Cancellation invoice with negative amounts that reverses an invoice
Kleinunternehmer	Small business that charges no VAT (§ 19 UStG)
ZUGFeRD / Factur-X	A PDF with a machine-readable invoice inside; EN 16931 is the European content standard
XRechnung	The German pure-XML e-invoice, needed by public bodies
RLS (row-level security)	Database rules deciding which rows a user may see or change
Edge Function	A small server program in the cloud, called by the app
Outbox	The phone's queue of changes waiting to be sent
Migration	A numbered database change script